Srinivasa Sai Chava

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Education

Boston University — Expected Dec 2026
M.S. in Artificial Intelligence — GPA: 3.78/4.00

Indian Institute of Information Technology Dharwad — May 2025
B.Tech. in Data Science and Artificial Intelligence — CGPA: 7.93/10.00

Technical Skills

Languages: Python, C++, Java
Machine Learning: PyTorch, scikit-learn, Hugging Face Transformers, LoRA/QLoRA, model evaluation
LLM Systems: Retrieval-augmented generation (RAG), LangChain, ChromaDB, FAISS, BM25, NLP
Software & Cloud: FastAPI, Flask, React, Node.js, PostgreSQL, MySQL, Docker, Git, Google Cloud Run, AWS

Experience

Technical Project Manager | BU Spark! — Sep 2026 – Present

- Selected to support technical delivery for client-sponsored ML teams in DS 549 (Machine Learning Practicum); project assignments begin September 2026.

AI / Machine Learning Intern | American Green Solutions — May 2026 – Aug 2026

- Built Astra AI, a solar-operations RAG assistant using **FastAPI, React, and ChromaDB**, with document ingestion, source citations, streamed answers, and JWT role-based access.
- Added semantic FAQ caching, per-model fallback, and token-usage tracking; cached answers bypass LLM calls, while usage controls manage model budgets.
- Shipped a **React/Node.js** company website with a Supabase PostgreSQL CMS and 20+ routes; deployed on Vercel and Google Cloud Run.

Machine Learning Research Assistant | IIIT Dharwad — Aug 2023 – Jul 2024

- Led a team comparing Google Translate and IndicTrans2 on IIT Bombay Hindi–English parallel text using semantic textual similarity and BLEU to assess translation quality.

Selected Projects

Autograder MET | Multimodal RAG Grading — GitHub | Jan 2026 – Present

- Built a rubric-based grading application with vision extraction and ChromaDB lecture retrieval; processed PDF, PPTX, and XLSX submissions across three LLM providers.
- Automated grading of real submissions took **about 3 minutes at $0.03 each**; calibration reduced the observed AI–instructor grading gap from **14 to 2 points**.

HateLens | Hierarchical Tamil Hate-Speech Detection — GitHub | Jul 2026

- Ranked **1st of 9 teams** in DravidianCodeMix 2026 Subtask 1, with **0.4603 mean macro-F1** across five label levels on the official test set.
- Combined fine-tuned MuRIL/XLM-R encoders with **QLoRA-adapted 7B models**; used factorized classification heads, prior-based calibration, and per-level ensembles for rare classes.

RAG Faithfulness and Attribution Evaluation — GitHub | Mar – May 2026

- Built a BM25/Contriever retrieval and Llama/Mistral generation pipeline with NLI claim scoring; ran five controlled experiments on retrieval, prompting, and adversarial evidence.
- Evaluated 50 human-annotated examples (**inter-annotator kappa = 0.74**); identified poor agreement between automated scoring and human judgments.

Selected Publications

ByteBreaker@DravidianLangTech 2026: XLM-RoBERTa Large with Sliding-Window Chunking and Top-K Mean Pooling for Writing Style Classification
DravidianLangTech workshop at ACL 2026 — Jul 2026

Hate Speech Detection in Telugu-English Code-Mixed Text (IIITDWD_SVC)
DravidianLangTech workshop at EACL 2024 — Mar 2024

Awards

CC-MMD 2026 Grand Challenge: 2nd place (Tamil), 2nd (English), 3rd (Chinese).
BU MedAI Hackathon: Winner (MedMax); **BU Civics Hack 2026:** Cyvl prize winner.